(U) The insurgents defended in depth and employed asymmetric tactics, firing from mosques, lobbing mortar rounds at American positions on the periphery, and staging hit-and-run attacks from the residential areas (see (U) Iraq: Asymmetric Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures Used at Fallujah and by the Mahdi Army for more information).

(U) Political Pressure Curtails Offensive Military Operations

(U) Political pressure to halt U.S. military operations began to build up immediately for several reasons:

- (U) Muqtada al-Sadr's militia, the Mahdi Army, began attacking Coalition forces on 2 April in response to the Coalition shutdown of his newspaper Hawza and the arrest of a top aide of Sadr. This simultaneous Shia uprising added to the pressure to resolve the Fallujah fight as quickly as possible. American solders and Marines were stretched thin fighting Sunnis across Al Anbar and Shia in Baghdad, Kut, and Najaf.

- (U) Other Sunni cells and groups escalated their attacks in areas outside Fallujah, especially in Ramadi. Twelve Marines were killed in Ar Ramadi on 6 April alone.

- (U) The British argued for a halt to the attack on Fallujah.

- (U) The Abu Ghurayb prisoner abuse scandal became public knowledge in late April and further enflamed Arab and Muslim anger at the United States.

- (U) Al Jazeera was claiming that up to 600 Iraqi civilians had been killed by the U.S. offensive. Images of dead children were being displayed repeatedly on televisions around the world.

- (U) The Iraqi Governing Council (IGC) began to unravel. Three members quit and 5 others threatened to quit, prompting CPA head Paul Bremer to agree to meet with the IGC on 8 April to discuss their concern over VIGILANT RESOLVE. The Sunni